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TORRANCE PLANNING COMMISSION – NOVEMBER 6, 2024

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At 8:23 p.m., Commissioner Obejas moved to adjourn the Planning Commission meeting to Wednesday, November 20, 2024, at 6:30 p.m. in the LeRoy J. Jackson Council Chambers.

November 6, 2024

MINUTES OF A REGULAR MEETING OF THE TORRANCE PLANNING COMMISSION

1. CALL MEETING TO ORDER

The Torrance Planning Commission convened in a regular session at 6:31 p.m. on Wednesday, November 6, 2024, in the LeRoy J. Jackson Council Chambers.

ROLL CALL

Present: Commissioners Anunson, Borgialli, Obejas, Riggs, Turner, Yeh, and Chair Kartsonis.

Absent: None.

Also Present: Planning Manager Leo Oorts, Planning Associate Natalie Niemeyer, Planning Associate Luis Velazquez, Planning Assistant Austin Lujan, Plans Examiner Uykheang Keo, Associate Engineer Anthony Maatubang, Senior Fire Prevention Specialist Chris Rhodes, Assistant City Attorney Tatia Strader, and Community Development Director Michelle Ramirez.

2. FLAG SALUTE

Commissioner Riggs led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. REPORT OF THE COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT STAFF ON THE POSTING OF THE AGENDA

Planning Manager Oorts stated that the agenda was posted on the Public Notice Board at 3031 Torrance Boulevard and on the City's Website on Thursday, October 31, 2024.

4. ANNOUNCEMENT OF WITHDRAWN, DEFERRED, AND/OR SUPPLEMENTAL ITEMS

Planning Manager Oorts reported Supplemental Items for Item 8B, Item 8C, and Item 8D.

MOTION: Commissioner Obejas moved to continue Item 8B to a date uncertain. Commissioner Anunson seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

5. ORAL COMMUNICATIONS – None.

6. CONSENT CALENDAR

6A. APPROVAL OF MINUTES: SEPTEMBER 4, 2024 AND SEPTEMBER 18, 2024

MOTION: Commissioner Turner moved to approve the September 4, 2024 and September 18, 2024 minutes. Commissioner Yeh seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

7. ADMINISTRATIVE MATTERS

7A. COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT – CONSIDER APPROVAL OF EXT24-00005: DAN BOLTON ENGINEERING CORPORATION

Recommendation of the Community Development Director that Planning Commission consider approval of a Time Extension for a previously approved Division of Lot (DIV22-00002) for condominium purposes, on property located in the R-3 Zone at 3828 226th Street. This item is exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to CEQA Guidelines Section 15061(b)(3). (Res. No. 24-068)

MOTION: Commissioner Obejas moved to approve the EXT24-00005. Commissioner Turner seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-068, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Time Extension for a previously approved Division of Lot (DIV22-00002) for condominium purposes, on property located in the R-3 Zone at 3828 226th Street.

MOTION: Commissioner Obejas moved to adopt Resolution Number 24-068. Commissioner Turner seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

8. HEARINGS

8A. COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT – CONDUCT A PUBLIC HEARING TO CONSIDER APPROVAL OF CUP24-00014: THE PAN BISTRO LLC (HR PROPERTY GROUP)

Recommendation of the Community Development Director that Planning Commission conduct a public hearing and consider approval of a Conditional Use Permit to allow beer and wine service at an existing restaurant, on property located in the C-2 Zone at 3160 Pacific Coast Highway. This project is Categorically Exempt from CEQA per Guidelines Section 15301 – Existing Facilities. (Res. No. 24-069)

Planning Assistant Lujan presented Item 8A.

Lili, a consultant with Liquor License Brokers, spoke on behalf of The Pan Bistro, LLC, who is requesting a Conditional Use Permit to allow the sale of beer and wine for onsite consumption. The previous tenant had a beer and wine license from 2013 through 2018, and the new operator [The Pan Bistro, LLC] is seeking to offer what the previous tenant offered. The Pan Bistro, LLC has several restaurants throughout Southern California that serve beer and wine.

Lili stated that current hours of operation are from 8:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m., but with the entitlement, the applicant is requesting an extension of hours from 8:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m.

No members of the public spoke.

Chair Kartsonis disclosed that he visited the location and will base decisions on evidence presented and personal observations.

Chair Kartsonis requested additional information on the hours of operation. Planning Manager Oorts stated that given the location of the site in the commercial center and being that the site is not next to single-family residences, staff did not find it necessary to limit hours of operation. The Torrance Police Department has reviewed the application and did not find any complaints filed at the location.

Chair Kartsonis inquired if there were previous restrictions on hours of operation. Lili replied that she was not aware, but that conditions will be put in place that will dictate the hours depending on the City's approval.

Planning Manager Oorts stated that out of abundance of caution, staff could recommend adding a Condition of Approval (Condition 17) that could meet the applicant's request, but if the hours of operation are listed on the previous entitlement that go beyond the requested time extension, that the hours would be honored upon approval of the Community Development Director at the administrative level. Staff has no objection to the time extension.

Commissioner Riggs disclosed that he visited the location and will base decisions on evidence presented.

MOTION: Commissioner Borgialli moved to close the public hearing. Commissioner Obejas seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

MOTION: Commissioner Borgialli moved to approve CUP24-00014 with the amendment to the Conditional Use Permit of Condition 17 as read by staff. Commissioner Turner seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-069, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Conditional Use Permit as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 5, Article 3 of the Torrance Municipal Code to allow beer and wine service at an existing restaurant, on property located in the C-2 Zone at 3160 Pacific Coast Highway.

MOTION: Commissioner Borgialli moved to adopt Resolution Number 24-069. Commissioner Obejas seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

8B. COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT – CONDUCT A PUBLIC HEARING TO CONSIDER APPROVAL OF PRE24-00007: JAVIER GONZALEZ-CAMARILLO (VICTOR AND CHRISTINA VEGA)

Recommendation of the Community Development Director that Planning Commission conduct a public hearing and consider approval of a Precise Plan of Development to allow the construction of a new two-story single-family residence, on property located within the Hillside Overlay in the R-1 Zone at 5340 Doris Way. This project is Categorically Exempt from CEQA per Guidelines Section 15303 – New Construction. (Res. No. 24-070)

Item 8B continued to a date uncertain.

8C. COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT – CONDUCT A PUBLIC HEARING TO CONSIDER APPROVAL OF PRE24-00003: DENISE TORRES (JONATHAN AND INGRID CHUA)

Recommendation of the Community Development Director that Planning Commission conduct a public hearing and consider approval of a Precise Plan of Development to allow the construction of a new one-story single-family residence, on property located within the Hillside Overlay in the R-1 Zone at 5614 Palos Verdes Boulevard. This project is Categorically Exempt from CEQA per Guidelines Section 15303 – New Construction. (Res. No. 24-071)

Planning Associate Velazquez presented Item 8C.

Ms. Melissa Reyes with 3A1 Development spoke on the project, an existing single-family, single-story residence with an existing detached ADU. The single-family residence will be demolished and will be replaced with a new single-family, single-story residence with an attached 2-car garage. The project will not exceed maximum heights in the R-1 Zone.

No members of the public spoke.

No members of the Commission spoke.

MOTION: Commissioner Borgialli moved to close the public hearing. Commissioner Obejas seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

MOTION: Commissioner Yeh moved to approve PRE24-00003. Commissioner Borgialli seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-071, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Precise Plan of Development as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 1, Article 41 of the Torrance Municipal Code to allow the construction of a new one-story single-family residence, on property located within the Hillside Overlay in the R-1 Zone at 5614 Palos Verdes Boulevard.

MOTION: Commissioner Obejas moved to adopt Resolution Number 24-071. Commissioner Borgialli seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

RECESSED: 7:00 p.m.
RECONVENED: 7:06 p.m.

ROLL CALL: All Commissioners present.

8D. COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT – CONDUCT A PUBLIC HEARING TO CONSIDER APPROVAL OF CUP23-00012, DVP23-00002, DIV23-00003, EAS23-00003, MOD23-00007, MOD23-00008: LENNAR HOMES (MADRONA F & F, LLC)

Recommendation of the Community Development Director that Planning Commission conduct a public hearing for consideration of an Environmental Assessment for adoption of a Mitigated Negative Declaration, and approval of a Conditional Use Permit and a Development Permit to allow the construction of a 260- unit townhome development, a Division of Lot to allow a Vesting Tentative Tract Map (No. 83498) for condominium purposes, a Modification of Variance (V79-3) pertaining to the off-street parking boundary for the Del Amo Fashion Center, and a Modification of Development Permit (DVP96-00001) pertaining to the Master Plan boundary for the Del Amo Fashion Center, on property located in the H-DA1 Zone at the northwest corner of Carson Street and Madrona Avenue at 3405 Carson Street and 21405, 21515 Madrona Avenue (APN 7366-019-123, 7366-019-182, 7366-019- 183), referred as the Fashion Square at Del Amo Project. (Res. Nos. 24-072, 24-073, 24-074, 24-075, 24-076)

Planning Manager Oorts presented Item 8D.

Mr. Don Lamb, representative for Lennar Homes, and Mr. Bryan Sevy, chief architect at KTGY Group, spoke on the project.

Mr. Lamb stated that the project has been designed by Lennar Homes, that community outreach was conducted, that height maximums will not be exceeded, and that the project is low density (General Plan Housing Element states that the site can have up to 552 units, Lennar Homes is proposing 260 units).

Mr. Lamb stated that the project will consist of ownership type housing with double-car garages for every unit, will feature open parking and guest parking, and stated that the potential buyer profile consisted of mature affluent couples and up and coming affluent couples.

Mr. Sevy provided a PowerPoint presentation on the project:

- There are several different housing types [luxury townhomes, luxury flats, and 3-story townhomes] proposed on the site that's organized around a central common space.
- The community park will be 34,000 square feet and will consist of water features, outdoor fireplace, BBQ, gathering areas, and outdoor play area.
- The property will have a central clubhouse with a pool and fitness area.
- A 20' landscape buffer will go along the perimeter roads of the property.

Mr. Lamb stated that the project has a Mitigated Negative Declaration, that the traffic impacts are very minimal, that traffic impacts are in the range of 600-800 daily trips, and that there will be no significant impacts in the community.

Robert, a volunteer for Madrona HOA, stated that he reviewed the plans and the plans submitted by Lennar Homes looked identical to the plans submitted to the City 20 years ago. Robert expressed concerns on parking, recommended permit parking along Madrona Avenue, and expressed concerns on the impact on utilities.

A member of the public spoke in favor of the project stating that he looked forward to the beautification of the City, saw the project as an improvement to the City, saw the project as taking pressure off the rental and real estate markets, and saw no major concern on parking issues.

Commissioner Riggs requested that the member of the public's parking concerns be addressed. Planning Manager Oorts replied that the project provides 699 parking spaces which equates to 2.7 spaces per unit, although this is below the Code requirement for 3.1 spaces per unit, State law [AB 297] does exempt the project from meeting the parking requirements due to the project being located within a 1.5-mile walking distance of a major transit center.

Chair Kartsonis disclosed that he visited the site and will base decisions on evidence presented and personal observations. He also disclosed that he is acquainted with John Lee who is advising on the project, that there is no financial relationship, and that decisions will be based on evidence presented and personal observations.

Commissioner Yeh inquired on shading for the community parks. Mr. Sevy replied that different elements of shading are being proposed which include trees provided around the park, shade canopies in play areas, and shaded amenity outdoor spaces.

Commissioner Yeh inquired if elevators are present on the property. Mr. Sevy replied that the luxury flats will have semi-private elevators and that there is opportunity for the luxury townhomes to have individual private elevators.

Commissioner Obejas inquired on daily trips and if data was prepared to compare with the old commercial space or with the existing restaurant. Mr. Lamb replied that the Institute of Traffic Engineers (ITE) gave generation rates which was applied to the industrial building and the restaurant building and that results showed that there was almost the same amount of traffic the new project would generate.

Andrew Fogg with Cox, Castle & Nicholson stated that the Mitigated Negative Declaration showed that the net daily trips saw a reduction of 45 trips per day compared to old usage.

Ryan Bensley with LSA Associates stated that the daily trip generation of 1,013 trips purely looked at all brand-new trips and not trips associated with the restaurant or the commercial building.

Commissioner Anunson disclosed that he has viewed the property and will base decisions based on presentation and discussions. He inquired on how the project was related to the Hawthorne Boulevard Development Corridor. Planning Manager Oorts replied that the project is located within the Hawthorne Boulevard Corridor Specific Plan area, and that staff reviewed the project plans and determined that the project conforms to the design guidelines and development standards.

Commissioner Riggs disclosed that he visited the site and will make decisions based on presentation.

Commissioner Obejas disclosed that he visited the property and will make decisions based on observations, evidence, and testimony provided.

Commissioner Borgialli provided insight on pipeline destinations and recommended that a Lennar Homes representative coordinate with refiners and pipeline affiliates.

Chair Kartsonis inquired if all electricity will be underground. Mr. Lamb confirmed.

Commissioner Turner disclosed that she visited the site and will base decisions on evidence provided.

MOTION: Commissioner Turner moved to close the public hearing. Commissioner Borgialli seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

MOTION: Commissioner Turner moved to approve CUP23-00012, DVP23-00002, DIV23-00003, EAS23-00003, MOD23-00007, MOD23-00008. Commissioner Obejas seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-072, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, adopting a Mitigated Negative Declaration for the Fashion Square at Del Amo Project in accordance with the California Environmental Quality Act.

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-073, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Conditional Use Permit as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 5, Article 1 of the Torrance Municipal Code to allow the construction of a 260-unit townhome development on property located in the H-DA1 Zone at the northwest corner of Carson Street and Madrona Avenue at 3405 Carson Street and 21405, 21515 Madrona Avenue (APN 7366-019-123, 7366-019-182, 7366-019-183).

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-074, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Development Permit as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 2, Article 36 of the Torrance Municipal Code to allow the construction of a 260-unit townhome development on property located in the H-DA1 Zone at the northwest corner of Carson Street and Madrona Avenue at 3405 Carson Street and 21405, 21515 Madrona Avenue (APN 7366-019-123, 7366-019-182, 7366-019-183).

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-075, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Division of Lot as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 2, Article 29 of the Torrance Municipal Code to allow a Vesting Tentative Tract Map (No. 83498) for condominium purposes on property located in the H-DA1 Zone at the northwest corner of Carson Street and Madrona Avenue at 3405 Carson Street and 21405, 21515 Madrona Avenue (APN 7366-019-123, 7366-019-182, 7366-019-183).

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-076, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Modification of Variance (V79-3) as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 2, Article 28 of the Torrance Municipal Code pertaining to the off-street parking boundary for the Del Amo Fashion Center on property located in the H-DA1 Zone at the northwest corner of Carson Street and Madrona Avenue at 3405 Carson Street and 21405, 21515 Madrona Avenue (APN 7366-019-123, 7366-019-182, 7366-019-183).

RESOLUTION: Planning Associate Niemeyer read the title of Resolution Number 24-077, a Resolution of the Planning Commission of the City of Torrance, California, approving a Modification of Development Permit (DVP96-00001) as provided for in Division 9, Chapter 2, Article 28 of the Torrance Municipal Code pertaining to the Master Plan boundary for the Del Amo Fashion Center, on property located in the H-DA1 Zone at the northwest corner of Carson Street and Madrona Avenue at 3405 Carson Street and 21405, 21515 Madrona Avenue (APN 7366-019-123, 7366-019-182, 7366-019-183).

MOTION: Commissioner Obejas moved to adopt Resolution Numbers 24-072, 24-073, 24-074, 24-075, 24-076, and 24-077 as read. Commissioner Turner seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

9. RESOLUTIONS – None.

10. COMMISSION ORAL COMMUNICATIONS

Commissioner Riggs, Commissioner Yeh, Commissioner Obejas, Commissioner Anunson, and Chair Kartsonis spoke.

11. ADJOURNMENT

MOTION: At 8:23 p.m., Commissioner Obejas moved to adjourn the Planning Commission meeting to Wednesday, November 20, 2024, at 6:30 p.m. in the LeRoy J. Jackson Council Chambers. Commissioner Borgialli seconded the motion; a roll call vote reflected 7-0 approval.

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Approved as submitted
February 19, 2025
s/ Rebecca Poirier, City Clerk